TPSai - Experts

Start of Block: Participant Information

Welcome and thank you for your interest! You are being invited to take part in the expert content evaluation of our planned scale about *Trust in Psychological Support from AI (TPSai).* Before you decide whether to participate, it is important that you take time to read the following information carefully and understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. If anything is unclear or if you would like more information, ask us using the contact information provided at the bottom of this page. **What is the purpose of the study?** The purpose of this study is to develop and validate a questionnaire that measures how much people trust generative AIs (like ChatGPT or Claude) for psychological support, such as discussing feelings, sharing worries, or seeking advice about relationships. As part of this process, we are conducting an expert content evaluation to assess whether the items in our scale are clear, relevant, and appropriate. This research is part of a PhD project at the University of Glasgow. **Why have I been invited to participate?** You have been invited because of your expertise in a relevant field, such as psychology, human-AI interaction, or psychometric scale development. Your professional judgement will help us assess the content validity of our scale items. **Do I have to take part?** No, participation is voluntary. If you do decide to take part, you will be asked to confirm your consent before starting the survey. You are free to withdraw at any time without giving a reason. **What will happen to me if I take part?** You will be shown each item from our scale and asked to judge whether it should be kept, dropped, or reworded. If you select 'Reword', you will be able to provide your suggested alternative wording directly in the survey. **What do I have to do?** You simply need to complete the online survey, which you can do at a time and place that is convenient for you. **What are the possible benefits of taking part?** You will receive no direct benefit from taking part in this study. However, your expert input will directly contribute to ensuring the content validity and rigour of a new psychometric scale, which may support future research and the development of more trustworthy AI systems. **What are the possible disadvantages and risks of taking part?** The main disadvantage of taking part is the time required to complete the survey. The survey asks you to evaluate items related to trust in AI for psychological support in your capacity as an expert, rather than asking about your personal experiences. We do not anticipate any significant risks from participation. However, if you feel uncomfortable at any point, you are free to pause or withdraw without providing a reason. **Will my taking part in this study be kept confidential?** We do not collect any personally identifiable information such as your name or contact details. You will be identified only by an ID number, and any responses you provide cannot be traced back to you. Survey data will be collected through Qualtrics (a secure university-approved platform). **What will happen to my data?** The University of Glasgow is the Data Controller for this study. We will collect and store your survey responses in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (2018). Once you submit the completed survey, we will not be able to remove your data as we will have no way to identify which responses are yours. The data will be kept for up

to 10 years in line with the University of Glasgow's retention policy. After this period, they will be securely destroyed in accordance with standard procedures. The anonymised data may be shared publicly through data sharing platforms. Your name or any identifying information will not appear in any publication or shared dataset. **What will happen to the results of the research study?** The results of this expert evaluation will be used to inform item selection and refinement for the final version of the scale. Findings will be published in academic journals, presented at conferences, and form part of a PhD thesis. Your individual responses will not be identifiable in any publication or report. If you would like to receive a summary of the study findings once they are available, please contact the Principal Investigator using the contact details provided at the end of this section. **Who is organising and funding the research?** This research is organised by the University of Glasgow and is part of a PhD project within the Social AI Centre for Doctoral Training. The research is funded by UK Research and Innovation (UKRI) through Grant Reference Number EP/S02266X/1. **Who has reviewed the study?** The project has been reviewed by University of Glasgow College of Medical, Veterinary & Life Sciences Ethics Committee. **Contact for Further Information** *Need information about the study?* Riccardo Volpato (Lead Researcher) r.volpato.1@research.gla.ac.uk *Have concerns about the research?* Professor Lisa DeBruine (Supervisor) lisa.debruine@glasgow.ac.uk *Questions about your data protection rights?* Glasgow University Data Protection Officer dp@gla.ac.uk *Thank you for taking the time to read this information.*

End of Block: Participant Information

Start of Block: Consent

I confirm that I am 16 or above.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

I confirm that I have read and understood the participant information displayed in the previous page.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

I have had the opportunity to think about the participant information displayed in the previous page, ask questions, and understand the answers I have been given.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

I confirm that I agree to the way my data will be collected and processed and that data will be stored for up to 10 years in University archiving facilities in accordance with relevant Data Protection policies and regulations.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

I confirm that I agree that anonymised data might be publicly shared and archived on data sharing platforms.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

I agree to take part in the study.

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

End of Block: Consent

Start of Block: Expertise

The purpose of our research is to develop and validate a questionnaire that measures how much people trust generative AIs (like ChatGPT or Claude) for psychological support, such as discussing feelings, sharing worries, or seeking advice about relationships. As part of this process, we are conducting an expert content evaluation to assess whether the items in our

scale are clear, relevant, and appropriate. Over the next three sections, you will review items from three sub-scales: *Trust*, *Distrust*, and *Corporate Distrust.* For each item, please indicate whether it should be: **Keep** – retain the item as written **Drop** – remove the item from the scale **Reword** – revise the item wording (a text box will appear next to this option for your suggested rewording) Responses to all questions are required. Before the items, please answer the two questions below.

Please select your type of relevant expertise

- ☐ Expert in the domain of interest (e.g. human-AI interaction, digital mental health)
- ☐ Expert in scale development

Which generative AI platform have you been using most frequently or are you most familiar with? Please select only one.

- ○ ChatGPT
- ○ Claude
- ○ Google Gemini
- ○ Microsoft Copilot
- ○ Meta AI
- ○ DeepSeek
- ○ Character.AI
- ○ Replika
- ○ Other _____

End of Block: Expertise

Start of Block: Trust

Section 1 of 3: Trust Items Thinking about ${PLAT/ChoiceGroup/SelectedChoicesTextEntry} (which we refer to as "the AI"), please evaluate each item from the *Trust* sub-scale.

The AI is available whenever I need.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I trust the AI to respond quickly to any request.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I trust that what the AI tells me is accurate and reliable.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I trust the AI to provide information that helps me manage my psychological challenges.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to analyze my issues objectively.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to easily recognise what I want to know.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to give me advice that is appropriate and well-tailored to my specific situation.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to remind me of what I need to do to feel better.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am confident I can guide the AI to give responses that meet my needs.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to reflect the feelings I share in a way that feels accurate.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to make me feel heard and validated.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I feel safe opening up to the AI.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to help me organise and clarify my thoughts about a difficult situation.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to help me understand the perspective of someone I am having difficulties with.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to help me gain new insights into my issues.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to help me see how my feelings and thoughts fit into what people commonly experience.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust that the AI will provide increasingly better psychological support in the future.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI can accurately determine whether my specific experiences indicate a mental health condition.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI as my primary psychological support system.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I trust the AI to replace human connections for emotional support.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I trust that feeling emotionally connected to the AI is beneficial for me.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I am more willing to trust the responses of the AI when it provides the sources it is drawing from.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I trust that the more information the AI has about me, the better it can support me.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

End of Block: Trust

Start of Block: Distrust

Section 2 of 3: Distrust Items Thinking about ${PLAT/ChoiceGroup/SelectedChoicesTextEntry} (which we refer to as "the AI"), please evaluate each item from the Distrust sub-scale.

I worry that the AI may tell me what I want to hear rather than what is helpful.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I doubt that the AI can effectively support someone with complex mental health conditions.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I doubt that the AI can consistently identify mental health crises.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I am concerned that relying on the AI might lead people to neglect human connections and friendships.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI might be too persuasive and reduce my critical thinking.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I worry that the way the AI expresses itself might lead me to trust its information more than I should.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

Even though the AI sounds human, our interactions lack the shared experience of human connections.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI's responses might be influenced by unfair social stereotypes.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI might express stigmatising attitudes about people with mental health conditions.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI operates without the ethical and regulatory accountability of licensed mental health practitioners.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that relying on the AI might keep me from actually connecting with real people who could help me.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

Effective emotional support relies on non-verbal elements that the AI cannot provide.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that during long conversations the quality of AI responses deteriorates.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

End of Block: Distrust

Start of Block: Corporate Distrust

Section 3 of 3: Corporate Distrust Items Thinking about the company that develops and owns ${PLAT/ChoiceGroup/SelectedChoicesTextEntry} (which we refer to as "the AI company"), please evaluate each item from the *Corporate Distrust* sub-scale.

I am concerned that the AI company may use my data in ways I do not approve of.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I doubt that the AI company is committed to reducing the environmental impact of their product.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI company treats my wellbeing as secondary to their commercial interests.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I doubt that the AI company takes sufficient responsibility for how their product affects users emotionally.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the AI company may expose my personal and sensitive information.

- ◯ Keep
- ◯ Drop
- ◯ Reword _____

I am concerned that the values of the AI company do not sufficiently align with my own.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

I am concerned that users like me have insufficient influence over how the AI company develops its product.

- ○ Keep
- ○ Drop
- ○ Reword _____

End of Block: Corporate Distrust